

[Table 24.11](#) shows a table for diagonal diamonds. The name comes from an article in *Technical Analysis of Stocks & Commodities* magazine, November 2018, by Igor R. Toshchakov. [Figure 24.6](#) shows a simplified drawing of his examples. Let's discuss the patterns before I talk numbers.

Look at AB, a diamond pattern he calls a single diagonal, where the top and bottom are connected by the longest trend in the pattern. It's a diamond pattern (yes, I could have drawn it better, so pretend it's a good-looking diamond), but the bottom (B) appears before the top (A). He says that this combination indicates the breakout will be downward.

Pattern CD is another single-diagonal diamond except the top (C) comes before the bottom (D). The predicted breakout direction from this pattern is upward.

The right portion of the figure shows two-diagonal diamond shapes. Instead of one trend connecting the top and bottom of the pattern, we see two equal or nearly equal lengths connecting the top and bottom. Two diagonals tend to be a bit squatter looking on the side with two touches (FG and IJ), so there's a bit of a difference between single- and two-diagonal shapes, making it easier to determine which is which.

In the top-right panel, trends EF and EG form the two longest segments. Notice how the lines do *not* connect to the bottom of the diamond (instead, price touches the sides and they straddle the bottom).

The bottom-right panel shows the pattern flipped upside-down. Trends HI and HJ connect the top and bottom. Again, they straddle the diamond's top peak where the trendlines join. Toshchakov says that with two-diagonal shapes, the breakout can be in either direction.

Single diagonal. I used 388 diamond tops found from May 1996 to April 2020. I went through each pattern and marked whether it was a single- or two-diagonal pattern and logged when the top and bottoms of the pattern appeared. [Table 24.11](#) shows the results in the lower portion of the table.

If you ignore whether the pattern is a single- or two-diagonal configuration, a downward breakout will happen 54% of the time and an upward breakout will happen 46% of the time. That's the benchmark for the breakout direction (from [Table 24.4](#)), which is what I want to test.